Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited

Pakistan HR Manual (Lahore)

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Applies to	All employees of Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited ("Simtora Pakistan" or "the Company") working in Lahore or elsewhere in Pakistan
Related manuals	Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002); HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001); International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001); IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001); Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001); Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001); Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001); Facilities and Office Administration Manual (SIM-FAC-001)

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Introduction

This manual sets the employment terms for people who work for **Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited**, the Pakistan subsidiary of Simtora Technologies, Inc., in the **Lahore R&D Center**. Lahore is Simtora's largest R&D center (about 45 employees) and is responsible for much of the engineering of Simtora Flow, the shared platform services and quality engineering.

It sits within the framework of the Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002). It replaces the U.S.-only parts of the HR Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001) for Pakistan employees (see 1.3) and states where the Company gives more than the law.

Important. Employment law in Pakistan is made at both federal and provincial level, and since the 18th Constitutional Amendment most labor matters in Lahore are governed by **Punjab** law. Rates, wage ceilings, contribution percentages and thresholds are notified by government and change, often each July. This manual states the Company's rule and refers to "the rate notified from time to time" where figures change. If the law gives an employee more than this manual, the law applies.

Principles

1. Simtora Pakistan is a full member of the Simtora family: same career framework, same ethical standards and the same access to leadership.
2. We follow Pakistani law carefully and **go beyond it** where we can.
3. We respect faith, family and community obligations.
4. We keep people safe, including on the way to and from work.

How to use this manual

- Questions go first to your manager, then to the Lahore HR team (`hr-intl@simtora.example`) and the International HR Lead.

- The Company will give you a copy of this manual and of the **Standing Orders** that apply to your employment, in English and Urdu, at onboarding.
- Employees sign the acknowledgement in Appendix A.

Part 1 – Employer, Legal Framework and Scope

1.1 Employer and Scope

- The employer is **Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited**, a private limited company registered with the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan (SECP) and registered with the Pakistan Software Export Board (PSEB), with its registered office in Lahore.
- The **Managing Director, Lahore R&D Center** is the Company's chief executive in Pakistan and leads the site day to day. HR support comes from the Lahore HR team and the International HR Lead.
- The manual applies to all employees, probationers, fixed-term employees, interns and trainees. It applies to contractors only through their contracts.
- The Company performs contract R&D for Simtora Technologies, Inc. and owns no product IP; all IP is assigned to the parent (see 8.3).

1.2 Legal Framework

The main laws that apply (the HR team and local counsel keep this list current):

Area	Main law (federal or Punjab)
Terms of employment	Industrial and Commercial Employment (Standing Orders) Ordinance 1968 and the Punjab Standing Orders; Punjab Shops and Establishments Ordinance 1969 for working hours, weekly holiday and leave in commercial establishments; employment contract
Wages	Punjab minimum wage notifications; Payment of Wages Act 1936
Social security	Employees' Old-Age Benefits Act 1976 (EOBI); Punjab Employees' Social Security Ordinance 1965 (PESSI)
Injury	Workers' Compensation Act 1923
Maternity	Maternity Benefit laws applicable in Punjab (maternity leave and pay)
Industrial relations	Punjab Industrial Relations Act 2010
Harassment	Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act 2010 (as amended in 2022)
Tax	Income Tax Ordinance 2001 (salary withholding); Finance Acts
Corporate	Companies Act 2017 (SECP)
Electronic crimes and privacy	Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act 2016; constitutional right to dignity and privacy
Foreign exchange	Foreign Exchange Regulation Act 1947 and State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) rules

1.3 How the HR Policy Manual Applies in Pakistan

See the table in SIM-HR-002 Section 1.2. In short:

- **Not applicable:** at-will employment (1.2), FLSA classification, paid holidays (6.1), PTO (6.2), sick and safe leave (6.3), FMLA (6.4), 401(k) and COBRA (6.9), resignation,

termination, job abandonment and final pay (9.1–9.4). This manual replaces them.

- **Apply with the changes in this manual:** onboarding (1.3), probation (1.4), pay (1.5), expenses (1.6), attendance (2.2), corrective action (2.3), PIPs (2.4), accommodation (4.1), safety (4.3), hours and hybrid work (5.1–5.3), parental leave (6.5), equipment and stipends (7.4), hardship advance (7.5), relocation (7.6) and travel (8.1).
- **Apply as written:** standards of conduct (1.7), acceptable use (1.9, subject to 8.2), performance (2.1), grievances (3.1), anti-harassment standards (3.2), whistleblowing (3.3), dress code (5.4), relationships (5.5), bereavement (6.6), learning (7.1), mobility (7.2) and recognition (7.3).

1.4 Local Authorities and Contacts

Subject	Body
Labour inspections, Standing Orders, wages	Punjab Labour and Human Resource Department
Industrial disputes	Labour Courts (Punjab); National Industrial Relations Commission for matters within its jurisdiction
Old-age benefits	Employees' Old-Age Benefits Institution (EOBI)
Health insurance for employees	Punjab Employees' Social Security Institution (PESSI)
Tax	Federal Board of Revenue (FBR); Punjab Revenue Authority (PRA) for provincial sales tax on services
Corporate	Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan (SECP)
Software exporters	Pakistan Software Export Board (PSEB)
Harassment complaints (appeal)	Provincial Ombudsman for Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace

Contacts in the Company: Lahore HR team and International HR Lead `hr-intl@simtora.example`; Ethics Line `ethics@simtora.example`; Audit Committee `audit@simtora.example`.

Part 2 – Hiring, Contracts and Probation

2.1 Recruitment, Right to Work and Background Checks

- Roles are advertised internally and externally with the **pay range** (SIM-HR-002 1.7). Candidates are selected on merit.
- Simtora hires Pakistani nationals and foreign nationals who hold the right to work in Pakistan. Foreign hires need the visa and permits the law requires; HR starts the process at least 90 days ahead.
- **Verification.** HR checks CNIC (or passport), educational certificates and previous employment, with the candidate's written consent. Criminal-record checks are made only for roles with finance, security or privileged-access duties, and only after a conditional offer.
- Employment of **minors**: Simtora does not employ anyone under 18 as an employee. Internships for students aged 18 or over follow 2.2.
- **Relatives** follow SIM-HR-001 5.5.

2.2 Appointment Letters and Employment Categories

Every employee receives a written **appointment letter** in English (and Urdu on request) **before or on the first day**. It states:

- name, role, department, reporting line and place of work;
- start date, employment category and probation;
- salary components, pay day and bank-transfer payment;
- hours, weekly rest, leave and holidays;
- notice period;
- confidentiality and IP terms (8.3);
- applicable Standing Orders, and the benefits (provident fund, medical cover, EOBI/PESSI where applicable);
- the right to raise a grievance and the Company's harassment code of conduct.

Category	Description
Probationer	New employee in the probation period (2.3)
Permanent	Confirmed in writing after probation
Fixed-term / project	Hired for a defined period or project; same leave and statutory protections on a pro-rated basis; does not become permanent unless stated, but repeated renewals to cover permanent work are avoided
Intern / trainee	Paid a monthly stipend not below the legally required amount; supervised; no more than 6 months
Contractor / consultant	Independent; HR and Legal classify before engagement (SIM-PRC-001 6.3); no employee benefits

2.3 Probation

- Probation is **3 months** from the start date. It may be **extended once, by up to 3 months** (6 months in all, the longest permitted), by written notice before the original period ends that states the reasons and the goals.
- The probation review (SIM-HR-001 Appendix C) is held at month 2.
- During probation the employee has the same leave entitlement, protection from discrimination and harassment, and wages as other staff. Probationers take annual leave only on a pro-rated basis from accrued days, but may use casual and sick leave from day 1.
- **Notice during probation:** either side gives **15 days' written notice or pay in lieu**. (The law may allow termination of a probationer with shorter notice; the Company chooses to give more.)
- At the end of probation HR issues a **confirmation letter** that states permanent status. If no letter is issued by 2 weeks after the extended period, HR will confirm the status in writing.

2.4 Onboarding

Follow SIM-HR-001 1.3 and SIM-HR-002 Appendix C, with these local steps: CNIC and NTN registration, bank account for salary, EOBI/PESSI registration where applicable, provident fund enrollment, medical-cover enrollment, signing of the Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement, emergency contacts, transport arrangements, security and safety induction, and delivery of the laptop and accounts (day 1). Mandatory training (security, privacy, code of conduct, anti-harassment) is completed within **30 days**.

Part 3 – Working Time, Remote Work and On-Call

3.1 Working Hours and Weekly Rest

Item	Rule
Standard week	Monday to Friday, 8 hours a day, 40 hours a week
Core hours	10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. Pakistan Standard Time (UTC+5), no daylight saving
Meal and prayer breaks	Unpaid or flexible break of at least **60 minutes** for lunch and prayer; the Friday congregational prayer (Jumu'ah) break is up to **90 minutes** and may be taken between 12:00 noon and 2:30 p.m. Time lost for prayer is not treated as lateness.
Maximum hours	No more than **9 hours a day** or **48 hours a week** including overtime, except where the law permits
Weekly rest	Saturday and Sunday (at least one full day a week, as the law requires)
Rest between days	At least **11 hours** between work days where practicable, including after incidents
Flexibility	Start between 8:00 a.m. and 11:00 a.m. with the manager's agreement, finishing after completing hours

Employees record attendance in the HR system (office check-in or remote check-in). Falsifying records is a disciplinary matter.

3.2 Overtime

- Employees whose role is covered by overtime provisions of Punjab law are paid **twice the ordinary rate of pay** for approved hours above 9 a day or 48 a week. HR classifies each role at hire. Many technical, managerial and supervisory roles are not covered, in which case the Company gives **time off in lieu** for approved extra hours over a month (SIM-HR-001 5.1).
- Overtime requires the manager's prior approval, except in a declared incident. It is always paid or compensated.
- No one is asked to work extra hours as a matter of routine.

3.3 Hybrid and Remote Work

- Hybrid by default: anchor days **Tuesday to Thursday**, at least 3 office days a week. Fully remote roles are approved under SIM-HR-001 5.2 and SIM-HR-002 1.9 and must be performed within Pakistan.
- Remote workers keep a safe workspace, a **backup power and internet plan**, and follow SIM-IT-001 4.6. The Company provides the home-office allowance and connectivity stipend (4.4).
- Working from outside Pakistan needs approval under SIM-HR-002 1.9.

3.4 On-Call and Follow-the-Sun

- Lahore teams are part of the follow-the-sun rota, normally covering **evening and night hours in the United States**. Regular on-call hours fall between **7:00 a.m. and 10:00 p.m.** Pakistan time; overnight on-call is backup only (SIM-HR-002 1.6).
- **On-call allowance** per rotation week is set in PKR by the Compensation Committee and published on the intranet. Call-out time actually worked is paid or compensated under 3.2 and counts toward weekly limits.
- Staff called out after **10:00 p.m.** receive safe transport home and a late start the next morning if they worked more than 2 hours.
- Employees may ask to leave the rota for health, religious or caregiving reasons.

3.5 Ramadan and Prayer Arrangements

- **During Ramadan** the standard working day is reduced by **1 hour at full pay** (7 hours), with core hours 10:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. and flexible starts. The reduction applies to everyone, not just those fasting.
- Quiet prayer rooms are provided in the office. Employees can pray at their desks or in the room without notice.
- Iftar is provided in the office on anchor days during Ramadan.
- Non-Muslim employees are free to observe their own holidays (5.1) and there are no requirements to participate in religious activity.

Part 4 – Pay, Payroll, Tax and Social Contributions

4.1 Salary Structure and Payment

- Salaries are in **Pakistani rupees (PKR)**, set from local market data (SIM-HR-002 1.7) and never below the minimum wage notified by the Government of Punjab.
- Salary is paid **monthly**, by **bank transfer** to the employee's account, on the **last working day of the month** and **never later than the 7th day after the end of the month**, as the Payment of Wages Act requires.
- The pay slip shows basic salary, allowances, overtime, deductions (tax, EOBI, provident fund) and net pay.
- Typical structure: **basic salary** (at least 60% of gross), house rent, utilities or medical allowance as applicable. The structure is set by the Tax team to be tax-efficient and lawful.
- Errors are reported within 30 days and corrected in the next pay run, or within 3 business days if the shortfall is more than PKR 10,000.
- The annual **merit cycle** runs with the Company cycle (SIM-HR-001 1.5); increments are effective April 1.

4.2 Deductions

Only these deductions are made: income tax, EOBI and PESSI employee contributions where applicable, provident fund contributions, deductions the employee has authorized in writing (for example, a hardship-advance repayment), and deductions that a court or the law requires. **The Company never deducts for lost or damaged equipment, mistakes or fines.** Overpayments are recovered only by written agreement on a schedule.

4.3 Income Tax and Statutory Contributions

Item	Rule
Income tax	Withheld by the Company each month under the Income Tax Ordinance 2001 at the rates in the current Finance Act; deposited with FBR by the due date (the 15th of the following month); annual salary certificate given by July 31
EOBI	Registration within the legal period; employer and employee contributions at the notified rate; paid monthly
PESSI (social security)	Employer contribution at the notified rate and wage ceiling, where the Company is covered; employees receive cards and medical benefits
Workers' Welfare Fund / Workers' Profit Participation Fund	Applied where the Company is liable (Tax and local advisers confirm each year)
Provincial taxes on services	Handled by Finance (SIM-GLB-001 Part 3)
Filing	Employees' tax certificates and annual statements prepared by Payroll; employees remain responsible for their own returns

4.4 Bonuses, Allowances and Equity

Item	Rule
Annual performance bonus	By plan document (SIM-HR-001 1.5), in PKR
Eid bonus	One half of one month's **basic salary** before **Eid ul Fitr** and before **Eid ul Adha** for employees who have completed 3 months of service (pro-rated for part-service); a customary benefit in Pakistan, provided as a Company benefit
On-call allowance	3.4
Home-office allowance	PKR equivalent of US $500 one-time (US$1,000 for fully remote), plus **backup power** support: a UPS or inverter for the home workstation where the home has frequent outages, up to the equivalent of US $300 per person
Connectivity stipend	PKR equivalent of US $75 per month; Simtora may instead provide a Company-paid mobile data connection
Learning budget	PKR equivalent of US $1,500 a year and 40 hours of paid learning time
Equity	Eligible roles may receive awards under the Equity Incentive Plan after Legal and Tax clear SBP, SECP and tax treatment (SIM-HR-002 1.7)

The exchange rate for PKR equivalents is the Finance monthly rate (SIM-FIN-001 2.5), reviewed at the start of each fiscal year. If the rupee moves by more than 10% in a year, Finance reviews allowances so they keep their real value.

4.5 Expenses and Business Travel

- Claims follow SIM-HR-001 1.6 and SIM-FIN-001 4.7: within 30 days, receipts above PKR equivalent of US $25, paid within **10 business days**, in PKR by bank transfer. Foreign-currency expenses are converted at the Finance rate.

- Business travel follows SIM-HR-001 8.1 with the changes in SIM-HR-002 1.8. Flights over 6 hours: economy or premium economy. Visa and travel insurance are arranged by the travel platform.
- **Security.** Travel within Pakistan to areas the Security team marks as high risk requires approval; travelers use Company-approved transport and share their itinerary (SIM-GLB-001 Part 5).
- Travel time on working days is working time.

Part 5 – Leave and Holidays

5.1 Public Holidays

- Simtora Pakistan gives **all public holidays notified by the Federal and Punjab Governments** for commercial establishments, with full pay. In a typical year there are **14 to 16** such days, including **Eid ul Fitr, Eid ul Adha, Ashura**, Pakistan Day (March 23), Labour Day (May 1), Independence Day (August 14), Iqbal Day (November 9) and Quaid-e-Azam Day (December 25). See Appendix B.
- Dates of Islamic holidays depend on moon sighting. HR announces the holiday as soon as the government notifies it, and if an Eid holiday is extended or moved by notification, the Company follows it.
- **Floating observance.** Employees who belong to another faith may take **2 days a year of paid leave** for their own holy days (for example, Christmas, Easter, Diwali, Holi, Guru Nanak's birthday) in addition to leave in 5.2, with their manager's approval. This is equivalent to the floating holidays in SIM-HR-001 6.1.
- If a public holiday falls on a weekly rest day, the Company gives no substitute unless the government declares one.

5.2 Casual Leave

- **10 days** per calendar year for short personal needs, taken with notice where possible; not carried over or encashed. Law: 10 days per year in commercial establishments.

5.3 Annual Leave

Item	Rule
Entitlement	**20 working days** per calendar year for all employees (law: 14 days after 12 months' service); pro-rated in the first year
Accrual	Accrues monthly from the start date; available to take after confirmation, or earlier with manager and HR approval
Request	In the HR system, with notice roughly double the leave length where possible; managers decide within 3 business days
Carry-over	Up to **10 days** carry over to the next calendar year; the rest expire on December 31 unless the manager and HR agree to an extension because business needs prevented leave
Encashment	Unused annual leave is **paid out at termination** (gross monthly salary ÷ 30 per day). During employment, up to 5 days a year may be encashed once the employee has taken at least 10 days of leave in the year
Rest	Employees are encouraged to take at least 10 consecutive working days once a year

5.4 Sick Leave

- **10 days** of paid sick leave per calendar year (law: 8 days), available from day 1.
- **Medical certificate** from a registered medical practitioner is required for absences of **more than 2 consecutive days**.
- Employees notify their manager or the HR system as early as possible on the first day.
- Prolonged illness: after sick leave is used, the employee may use annual leave or unpaid leave. HR meets the employee to discuss support, adjustments and any entitlement under the PESSI, group disability cover or Workers' Compensation Act.
- Absence due to a work injury is not charged to sick leave; workers' compensation or PESSI benefits are claimed and the Company tops up pay to 100% for up to 90 days.

5.5 Maternity, Parental and Adoption Leave

Entitlement	Rule
Maternity leave	**12 weeks paid at full pay** (generally 6 weeks before and 6 weeks after delivery, or as the doctor advises), for employees who have completed the service required by law (currently 4 months). Simtora applies it to all employees from the start of employment. The Company's 12 weeks for a primary caregiver (SIM-HR-002 1.5) is met by this leave.
Extended leave	A further **up to 12 weeks unpaid** on request, without loss of job or benefits accrual
Secondary caregiver (partner) leave	**6 weeks paid at 100%** after 6 months of service (no statutory right in Punjab for private-sector fathers, so this is a Company benefit)
Adoption / surrogacy / foster	Same as the matching category
Miscarriage or stillbirth	Paid leave as the doctor advises, with at least 2 weeks; plus bereavement leave on request
Return	The same or an equivalent job; breastfeeding breaks and a private room (SIM-FAC-001); phased return on request; childcare support through the Employee Assistance Program
Protection	An employee cannot be dismissed because of pregnancy or leave. Maternity pay is not deducted from annual or sick leave.

5.6 Bereavement, Marriage and Other Leave

Leave	Rule
Bereavement	5 paid days (spouse, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, grandchild, in-law, or household member) and 3 paid days for other close relatives or friends; additional days from annual leave or unpaid
Marriage leave	**5 paid days** once during employment for the employee's own marriage
Pilgrimage (Hajj / Umrah / other religious)	Employees can use annual leave; after 3 years of service, up to **30 days of unpaid leave** once for Hajj or another major pilgrimage, with job protection
Jury or court attendance	Paid for required attendance as a witness or party in a legal proceeding relating to work; otherwise by annual or unpaid leave
Voting	Paid time to vote if the polling station is far from work
Volunteer time	2 paid days a year (SIM-HR-001 6.7)
Unpaid personal leave	Up to 90 days with 12 months' service (SIM-HR-001 6.8)
Study and exam leave	Up to 5 paid days a year for approved professional exams

Part 6 – Benefits and Retirement

6.1 Health and Life Cover

- **Group health insurance** for the employee, spouse and up to four dependent children, with inpatient (hospitalization), maternity and outpatient cover, within limits stated in the benefits guide; effective from day 1. The Company pays the full premium for the employee and a substantial portion for dependents.

- **Group life insurance** and **accidental death and disability cover**, paid by the Company.
- Where PESSI applies, PESSI benefits are claimed first and the Company's insurance supplements them.
- Employee Assistance Program (counseling in English and Urdu) and an annual health check.

6.2 Provident Fund, Gratuity and EOBI

Scheme	Rule
Provident Fund	A recognized contributory provident fund under the Income Tax Rules: the employee contributes **10% of basic salary**; the Company contributes **10%**; contributions are invested by trustees; the employee is entitled to the employer's contribution after **3 years of service** in full (vesting: 50% after 1 year, 75% after 2 years, 100% after 3 years), and to their own at any time on leaving
Gratuity	For employees who are covered by gratuity rules under the Standing Orders and who have completed the qualifying service, gratuity is paid on termination or retirement at the rate the Standing Orders set (30 days of last drawn wages for each completed year of service). Where gratuity applies, the Provident Fund employer contribution is offset only as the law permits
EOBI	Registration and contributions by employer and employee at the notified rate; employees get old-age, invalidity and survivors' pensions from EOBI

Employees receive a statement of provident fund balance every year.

6.3 Other Benefits

- **Transport.** Pick-and-drop transport or a monthly transport allowance for employees who commute to the office; Company-arranged transport for all staff who finish after **8:00 p.m.** (6.3 and 10.2).
- **Meals.** Lunch on anchor days; Iftar during Ramadan.

- **Wellness stipend** and gym or sports activities as the benefits guide states.
- **Laptop and equipment** (SIM-HR-001 7.4); **learning budget** (4.4).
- **Annual all-hands** in San Francisco for selected representatives and an annual team gathering in Lahore.
- **Recognition** and service awards at 1, 3, 5, 10 and 15 years.

Part 7 – Equality, Respect, Employee Voice and Speaking Up

7.1 Equal Opportunity

Simtora does not discriminate on grounds of sex, gender, religion or belief, sect, ethnicity, caste, language, nationality, disability, age, marital status, pregnancy, or any other protected ground. The Company considers women for all roles and works to increase women's participation in engineering through targets for hiring, flexible work, safe transport and mentoring.

Reasonable adjustments are made for employees with disabilities (access, equipment, flexible hours) under SIM-HR-001 4.1. Religious practice is accommodated within business needs (3.5, 5.1).

7.2 Protection Against Harassment

The Company follows the **Protection against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act 2010** (as amended) and applies the same protection to all employees regardless of gender, as the Global People Standards require.

Item	Rule
Code of Conduct	The Company displays the statutory Code of Conduct in English and Urdu at every office and gives it to every new employee.
Inquiry Committee	The Company maintains a standing **Inquiry Committee of three members**, at least one of whom is a woman, with a senior manager and one other member (an HR representative or a senior employee). Members are trained and none is a manager of the complainant or the accused.
How to complain	To any member of the Inquiry Committee, HR, the Ethics Line, or (for the Executive Team) the Audit Committee. Written or verbal complaints are accepted.
Timeline	Complaint acknowledged within **2 business days**; the Committee begins the inquiry promptly and completes it **within 30 days** of the complaint, as the Act requires; the Company implements the recommended penalty within **7 days** of receiving the Committee's findings.
Interim steps	Where needed, the Company changes reporting lines, seating or work arrangements, or places the accused on leave with full pay, to protect the complainant, without prejudging the outcome.
Penalties	Range from censure to dismissal as the Act provides. No deduction from pay is used except as the Act or a court requires.
Appeal	Either side may appeal to the Provincial Ombudsman within 30 days of the decision.
Retaliation	Prohibited and treated as serious misconduct.
Reporting	An annual report on cases is sent to the Compliance Officer; every case is also reported to the Compliance Officer and the Chief People Officer (SIM-CMP-001 2.4).

The same procedure and timelines apply to **bullying and other harassment** not covered by the Act.

7.3 Grievance Procedure

1. **Raise it** with your manager or the Lahore HR team (verbal or written).
2. **Formal grievance.** Written grievance to HR. HR acknowledges within **3 business days**, investigates and replies in writing within **15 days**.
3. **Appeal** to the International HR Lead and the Managing Director within 7 days of the reply. A decision within 15 days.
4. **Labour Court.** If the grievance is not settled, an employee may bring a grievance petition to the Labour Court within the time limit the law sets after a written grievance notice. The Company does not penalize anyone for doing so.

7.4 Employee Representation

- Employees may form or join a union and bargain collectively under the Punjab Industrial Relations Act 2010. The Company does not interfere with or retaliate against employees for lawful union activity.
- If the Company reaches the headcount at which the law requires a works council or similar body, it will establish one. Until then, the Company holds employee forums at least **twice a year** with the Managing Director and the Chief People Officer (or delegate), and an elected employee representative sits on the Facilities & Workplace Committee.

7.5 Speaking Up

- Employees can report concerns to the Ethics Line (`ethics@simtora.example` , anonymous reports accepted) or the Audit Committee. Reports are acknowledged within **5 business days**.
- Pakistan has no general statute protecting private-sector whistleblowers. The Company therefore applies its own non-retaliation rule strictly (SIM-CMP-001 2.3). Retaliation is serious misconduct.
- Employees may report to regulators (FBR, SECP, Labour Department) at any time without prior permission.

Part 8 – Safety, Privacy and Intellectual Property

8.1 Health, Safety and Travel

- The Company provides a safe and healthy workplace under the law and SIM-FAC-001: fire detection and drills (at least twice a year), trained first aiders (at least 2 per office and 1 per 50 on site), emergency exits, and building security.
- **Injuries** are reported the same day. Employees are entitled to workers' compensation or PESSI benefits (5.4).
- **Emergency numbers:** 15 (police), 1122 (Rescue 1122: ambulance, fire, rescue) and the site security line posted in the office.
- **Commuting and travel.** Transport for after-hours work (6.3). Travelers share itineraries and follow Security's advice on routes and areas. Employees may decline travel they believe is unsafe without penalty.
- **Women's safety.** Transport, lighting, and secure entrances are checked each quarter; staff may use the Company's safe-transport service at no cost whenever they stay after 8:00 p.m.
- **Mental health.** Stress, long hours and on-call work are monitored by managers and HR; the Employee Assistance Program is available 24/7.

8.2 Privacy, Monitoring and Records

- Pakistan does not have a comprehensive data-protection statute in force on the effective date of this manual; the Company applies the global standard in SIM-HR-002 1.12 and the Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act 2016. If a data-protection law is enacted, HR and Legal will update this manual.
- **Monitoring.** Company devices and systems are monitored for security and business purposes under SIM-IT-001 4.8. Employees are notified in writing of what is monitored and why (this manual and the acknowledgement in Appendix A). The Company does not monitor personal devices, personal accounts or private places.

- **Employee data** is held in the HR system under access controls and transferred to the U.S. under the intra-group agreement. Employees can request access to and correction of their data (`privacy@simtora.example`).
- **Records.** Personnel and payroll records are kept during employment and for **7 years** after, tax records for the period FBR requires, EOBI/PESSI records as those bodies require.

8.3 Confidentiality, Intellectual Property and Restrictive Covenants

- All IP created in the course of employment belongs to the Company's parent, **Simtora Technologies, Inc.** The employee signs the Confidentiality and Invention Assignment Agreement at onboarding, which assigns present and future rights (including copyright and moral rights as far as permitted by Pakistani law).
- Employees keep confidential information secret during and after employment (SIM-HR-001 1.8).
- **Non-compete.** A restraint of trade after employment is enforceable in Pakistan only if reasonable and necessary. The Company uses non-competes for senior or sensitive roles only, for no more than **6 months**, and with Legal approval. Non-solicitation of customers and employees for up to 12 months is permitted.
- **Protected rights:** nothing restricts reporting wrongdoing to authorities or using Company channels.

Part 9 – Performance, Discipline and Separation

9.1 Performance Management

SIM-HR-001 2.1 applies: objectives, regular one-to-ones, mid-year and annual review, calibration. Performance concerns are discussed early. A performance improvement plan

(PIP) lasts **60 to 90 days** with clear goals, support and weekly reviews. Employees may bring a colleague to formal review meetings.

9.2 Discipline and Inquiry

Discipline follows the Standing Orders and the following steps. HR must be involved from the start.

Step	Detail
Informal	A conversation and note for minor matters
Verbal and written warning	For repeated or moderate issues; recorded; employee may respond in writing
Show-cause notice / charge sheet	For serious misconduct: written statement of the charge and facts; at least **7 days** to reply
Inquiry	An impartial inquiry officer or committee, not involved in the matter, hears the employee (who may bring a colleague), reviews evidence and reports
Decision	Written decision with reasons by the Department Head and HR (Chief People Officer for dismissals)
Suspension	Only where necessary for the inquiry; suspended employees receive their pay (for the period allowed by the Standing Orders and not less than the law requires)
Appeal	To the International HR Lead and the Managing Director within 7 days; decision in 15 days

Examples of serious misconduct: theft, fraud, serious breach of security or confidentiality, harassment, violence, serious safety violations, falsifying records, bribery, and serious or repeated insubordination. The Company records the reasons and keeps the file for 7 years.

9.3 Resignation

- **Notice: one month's written notice** after confirmation (15 days during probation). Senior roles (Manager and above) may be asked for more as the appointment letter states, up to 2 months.
- The Company may release the employee earlier with pay for the remaining notice. The Company may place the employee on garden leave with full pay.
- A handover plan is agreed (SIM-HR-001 9.1). Unused annual leave can be used during notice with the manager's agreement.
- A resignation can be withdrawn only with the Company's agreement.

9.4 Termination by the Company

- **Notice:** permanent employees receive **one month's written notice or one month's pay in lieu** (more for senior roles as in the appointment letter), unless terminated for misconduct after an inquiry.
- **Valid reasons** include misconduct (after inquiry), poor performance after a fair process, redundancy or restructuring, long-term incapacity, loss of a legal requirement to work, or other business reasons. Reasons are given in writing.
- **No termination** for pregnancy or maternity leave, union activity, raising a grievance or a harassment complaint, or any discriminatory reason.
- **Redundancy:** HR and Legal review the selection criteria; employees receive notice and **severance of one month's pay for each completed year of service, subject to a minimum of two months'** (this is better than the minimum under the Standing Orders); the Company considers redeployment and gives outplacement support. Retrenchment is reported to the Labour Department as the law requires.
- **Job abandonment** (SIM-HR-001 9.3) applies in this form: if an employee is absent without notice for **5 consecutive working days**, the Company writes to the employee at their registered address and email asking them to explain within 7 days; if there is no reply, the Company follows the Standing Orders procedure (show-cause and inquiry); only then is employment ended.
- **Challenging a termination.** The employee may bring a grievance to the Labour Court under 7.3. HR keeps evidence of the process.

9.5 Final Settlement and Offboarding

Item	Timing
Salary to last day	Within **2 working days** of termination by the Company; on the next pay day for resignation (and within 7 days of the end of the month, as in 4.1)
Leave encashment, bonus owed, expenses	Within **14 days** of the last day
Provident fund	Paid per the trust rules, normally within 30 days
Gratuity	Within 30 days where payable
Service / experience certificate	Within **7 days** of request
Clearance	Return of laptop, badge and property within 7 days; the Company arranges collection; no money is withheld to force a return
Access	IT removes access at or before the end of employment (SIM-IT-001 3.3)
Exit interview	Offered to every leaver
References	Through HR only (SIM-HR-001 9.5)

Part 10 – Local Practices

10.1 Working with Lahore and U.S. Teams

- Lahore is 12 to 13 hours ahead of San Francisco (Pakistan has no daylight saving). The practical shared window with San Francisco is **7:00–8:00 a.m. Pacific = 8:00–9:00 p.m. in Lahore**; with London and Berlin about 1:00–5:00 p.m. in Lahore. Teams must use written handoffs and asynchronous decisions, and **rotate evening meetings** so the same Lahore colleagues do not carry the burden (SIM-HR-002 1.6).

- Lahore leaders receive the same communications and decision notes as San Francisco leaders on the same day.
- Lahore engineers have equal access to promotion, visibility and the annual all-hands.

10.2 Security, Power and Connectivity

- The office has backup power (UPS and generator that keep core systems up for at least 8 hours) and **two internet providers** with automatic failover (SIM-FAC-001; SIM-GLB-001 Part 5).
- Business connectivity and any VPN used for the Company are registered with the Pakistan Telecommunication Authority (PTA) as required (SIM-GLB-001 Part 1).
- The building has security staff, CCTV (no audio, not in private spaces, 30-day retention) and visitor control as SIM-FAC-001 requires.

10.3 Air Quality, Heat and Monsoon

- **Smog (October to January).** When the air quality index in Lahore is above **300** (hazardous) or the Punjab government declares a smog emergency, managers allow remote work on request and the office runs air purifiers; masks are available. Employees with respiratory conditions may work from home on any poor-air-quality day.
- **Heat (April to September).** Cooling is maintained; staff avoid outdoor work in extreme heat; the transport schedule is adjusted if needed.
- **Monsoon (July to September).** If flooding or heavy rain makes the commute unsafe, the Site Lead decides on closure or remote work by 6:00 a.m. (SIM-FAC-001), and employees are never penalized for staying safe.

Appendices

Appendix A – Key Terms Summary and Acknowledgement

Item	Summary
Employer	Simtora Technologies (Pvt.) Limited
Hours	Mon–Fri, 8 h/day, core 10:00–15:00 PKT
Probation	3 months, extendable once by up to 3 months; 15 days' notice
Pay	Monthly, last working day, bank transfer, PKR
Annual leave / casual / sick	20 / 10 / 10 days
Maternity / partner leave	12 weeks / 6 weeks, full pay
Public holidays	As notified, about 14–16, plus 2 days for other faiths
Notice	1 month (both sides) after confirmation
Provident fund	10% employee, 10% employer
Harassment	Inquiry Committee; 30-day inquiry; appeal to Ombudsman

Acknowledgement. I have received this Pakistan HR Manual (version ___) and the Standing Orders that apply to me, in English (and Urdu on request). I understand that the Company monitors Company systems as described in 8.2, and that nothing in this manual restricts my right to report wrongdoing to the authorities or to take part in lawful union activity.

Employee name (print)	
Signature	
Date	
Employee ID / Role	

Appendix B – Public Holiday Calendar Rules

Holiday	Usual date	Notes
Kashmir Solidarity Day	February 5	
Pakistan Day	March 23	
Eid ul Fitr	Moon-based (3 days)	Dates announced by the government
Labour Day	May 1	
Youm-e-Takbeer	May 28	If notified
Eid ul Adha	Moon-based (3 days)	Dates announced by the government
Ashura	9–10 Muharram (2 days)	
Independence Day	August 14	
Eid Milad un Nabi	12 Rabi ul Awwal	
Iqbal Day	November 9	If notified
Quaid-e-Azam Day / Christmas Day	December 25	

HR publishes the calendar by **December 1** and updates it when the government notifies changes.

Appendix C – Disciplinary and Harassment Timelines

Process	Key times
Harassment complaint acknowledged	2 business days
Harassment inquiry completed	30 days
Penalty implemented after findings	7 days
Appeal to Ombudsman	30 days
Show-cause reply time	at least 7 days
Disciplinary appeal	7 days to file, 15 days to decide
Grievance reply	15 days
Final salary after termination by the Company	2 working days

Appendix D – Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change	Approved by
1.0	October 5, 2026	HR	Initial release	CEO (October 5, 2026)

End of document – SIM-HR-101